

Ethos+Story

1. Why unLecture Exists

The three of us met in college, a space that felt nourishing and intellectually alive. There was always something new to be curious about, something to think through together. Learning did not stay confined to classrooms. Conversations unfolded slowly, without the pressure of conclusions or outcomes, and genuine curiosity had the time and space to breathe.

That atmosphere quietly disappeared once we stepped into the working world.

Outside college, conversations began to feel increasingly functional or superficial. Learning almost always came with an agenda, often framed around productivity, upskilling, or optimisation. It was now rarely pursued for pleasure, depth, or intellectual expansion. The kinds of ideas, debates, and stimulation we once took for granted became strangely inaccessible, unless one deliberately sought out niche communities, closed academic spaces, or online forums.

What was missing was an *offline rhythm* in the city, a recurring space where thinking together felt normal.

unLecture emerged from a desire to de-pedestalise important conversations and intriguing ideas. To take discussions that had become hyper-specialised, jargon-heavy, or intimidating, and bring them back into the realm of everyday life, not by diluting them, but by making them speakable again.

Delhi is an amazing place to begin. There was already an appetite for thinking spaces with communities such as reading groups, book clubs. There was a large audience for the types of conversations we wanted to have but they didn't have any place to really go to. Our first unLecture event confirmed this instinct. The encouragement and excitement we encountered made it clear that people wanted to be challenged, nourished, and taken seriously.

We want to remain closely tied to the context unLecture was born out of - our cities, our culture, our environment and to hold thoughtful, grounded conversations about them.

unLecture is not only about making ideas accessible. It is also about creating a new way to spend time in the city: a continuous rhythm of familiar faces, recurring evenings, and evolving formats. A space where community forms organically. You learn something, meet people you wouldn't otherwise meet, and encounter ideas that stay with you.

At its core, unLecture responds to a gap many people feel after college—the sudden disappearance of spaces where thinking together feels natural. We are trying to rebuild that stimulation without the sterility, hierarchy, or intimidation that often accompanies formal academic settings.

2. Ethos & Non-Negotiables

unLecture is not a rigid academic space, and it is never meant to feel intimidating or closed.

We see it as a welcoming, people-first cultural initiative. While the ideas discussed are often serious and complex, the atmosphere is deliberately open. No one needs prior expertise, institutional affiliation, or the “right” language to belong in the room.

As unLecture has grown, it has become much larger than the three of us or our personal interests. The people who attend - their questions, curiosities, and conversations actively shape what the space becomes.

unLecture is not about upskilling, productivity, or self-optimisation. It is about cultivating better conversations. About meeting people more deeply. About engaging with ideas without treating them as tools, content, or credentials.

We think of unLecture as a way to spend time well: an evening that feels meaningful rather than efficient, nourishing rather than extractive. A space where learning happens socially, and where curiosity is not something you outgrow after college.

About Us

A space in the city where your curiosity is nourished

The three of us met in college, a space that felt nourishing and intellectually alive. Learning did not stay confined to classrooms. Conversations unfolded slowly, without the pressure of conclusions. Genuine curiosity had time and space to breathe.

That atmosphere quietly disappeared once we stepped into the working world. Outside college, conversations became increasingly functional or superficial. Learning almost always came with an agenda, framed around productivity, upskilling, or optimisation. Rarely pursued for pleasure, depth, or intellectual expansion.

What was missing was an offline rhythm in the city.

A recurring space where thinking together felt normal, and in-depth conversations with strangers were encouraged

unLecture emerged from a desire to de-pedestalise important conversations and intriguing ideas. To take discussions that had become hyper-specialised, jargon-heavy, or intimidating and bring them back into everyday life. Not by diluting them. By making them speakable again.

Delhi had an appetite for exactly this. Reading groups, book clubs, scattered communities, there was already hunger for thinking spaces, but nowhere consistent to go. Our first event confirmed the instinct. People wanted to be challenged, nourished, and taken seriously.

We are now trying to take this space pan-India! The formats are ever-evolving. unLecture is shaped by the people who show up, their questions, curiosities, and conversations.

What We Believe

★ NO CREDENTIALS REQUIRED

No prior expertise, institutional affiliation, or the right language. The room is open. Everyone belongs here.

★ IDEAS WITHOUT AGENDA

unLecture is not about upskilling, productivity, or self-optimisation. It is about cultivating better conversations. Engaging with ideas without treating them as tools, content, or credentials.

★ AN EVENING SPENT WELL

Meaningful rather than efficient. Nourishing rather than extractive. You learn something, you meet people you wouldn't otherwise meet, and the ideas stay with you.

★ ROOTED IN THE CITY

Closely tied to the context unLecture was born from, our cities, our culture, our environment. Thoughtful, grounded conversations about things that matter here.

Curiosity Should Never Be Confined To Institutions

Inspos (brands)

- Gully Labs - Story telling, visual identity, blend of Indian and Western aesthetics eally neatly
- Subko - Cohesiveness, rooted in India region/culture
- [Excise Department](#) - Interaction

Core Pages & Content Logic

Home + About (Main Landing Page)

Purpose

The Home and About pages together should orient a visitor into what unLecture is, why it exists, and what kind of space it is, without overwhelming them.

It is an introduction to a cultural space, not a page for marketing

Must convey

- What unLecture is, in clear and simple terms
- The ethos behind it: slow thinking, public learning, shared curiosity
- Our aesthetic, language, and tone (editorial, restrained, human)
- What we offer:
 - In-person lectures and conversations
 - A growing community around ideas
- Why this space exists and what gap it responds to

Tone & language

- Calm, editorial, and precise
- Inviting but not overly friendly
- Serious without being academic
- No hype, no jargon, no exaggeration

Must not

- Sound like a manifesto
 - Feel like a brand deck or pitch
 - Over-explain or oversell
 - Use buzzwords or startup language
-

Sub-pages:

Events (Upcoming)

Purpose

To give clear and easy access to upcoming lectures.

Key notes

- This page should allow people to:
 - See what's coming up

- Understand the topic, speaker, date, and venue quickly
- Ideally, users should be able to book tickets directly through the site
- For now, this page can redirect to external listing / ticketing pages
- Since we update every month and may need weekly revisions, this page should be able to support that

Must convey

- Clarity and seriousness
 - Continuity (this is an ongoing series, not one-off events)
-

Archive (Past Lectures)

Purpose

To function as a public memory of unLecture.

Key notes

- Archive of previous lectures and events
- Ideally organised chronologically, similar to a calendar view
- Each entry may include:
 - Title
 - Speaker
 - Date and venue
 - Short description or theme
 - Some media-posters etc

Tone

- Archival, not promotional
 - Emphasis on continuity and intellectual range
-

Community / Writing (Substack / Blog)

Purpose

To showcase the heart of unLecture: its people, conversations, and thinking.

Key notes

- This page can function as:
 - A newsletter hub
 - A blog / Substack integration

- Content may include:
 - Reflections from lectures
 - Writing by the team
 - Community contributions
- This space should feel personal, reflective, and alive

Must convey

- unLecture is not just events, it is a growing intellectual community
 - Ideas continue beyond the room
-

Contact / Collaborations

Purpose

To keep communication open, clear, and selective.

May include

- Contact email: **teamunlecture@gmail.com**
- Links to social media pages
- Brands and venues we've collaborated with
- Features or mentions in newspapers and publications
- Newsletter sign-up

Tone

- Open but not transactional
- Professional, warm, and uncluttered

NO GOs

Clear Red Lines

(Things we intentionally want to avoid)

- No distracting pop-ups
- No urgency-driven calls to action
 - e.g. “Only 2 seats left”, countdown timers, artificial scarcity
- No aggressive or repetitive CTAs
- No dark UX patterns designed to extract attention or action

We want unLecture to feel **credible, considered, and quality-first**. Urgency and pressure undermine trust and seriousness.

Design & Experience Checkpoints

(Principles we want to continually return to)

- **Readability and accessibility are essential**
 - Clean layouts
 - Comfortable typography
 - Clear hierarchy
 - Mobile compatibility is non-negotiable
- **Restraint over busyness**
 - The website should feel calm and uncluttered
 - Nothing should compete unnecessarily for attention
- **Trust as a design outcome**
 - The site should signal care, credibility, and thoughtfulness

- Visual choices should feel deliberate rather than trendy
- **An engaging place to spend time**
 - The website should invite browsing, not rushing
 - Users should feel comfortable lingering, reading, and returning